

Meridian Logistics Employee Handbook

Version 2024 | Human Resources Department | Lahore, Pakistan

1. Purpose and Scope

This handbook sets out the terms of employment, entitlements and expected conduct for all permanent and contract staff of Meridian Logistics (Private) Limited. It applies to head office, warehouse and depot personnel across all locations. Where a written individual contract conflicts with this handbook, the individual contract prevails.

2. Working Hours

Standard office hours are 09:00 to 18:00, Monday to Friday, including a one hour unpaid break. Warehouse staff operate on a shift rota published two weeks in advance by the depot supervisor. Overtime must be approved in advance by a line manager and is compensated at 1.5 times the standard hourly rate.

3. Probation

All new employees serve a probation period of **3 months** from their start date. During probation either party may terminate the employment with one week of written notice. A probation review meeting is held at the midpoint and again before confirmation. Probation may be extended once, by a maximum of one month, where the review is inconclusive.

4. Annual Leave

Confirmed employees are entitled to **14 days of paid annual leave per calendar year**, accruing monthly. Leave requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least seven working days in advance and require line manager approval. Up to 5 days of unused leave may be carried into the following year; any balance above that is forfeited on 31 December.

Public holidays gazetted by the Government of Pakistan are observed in addition to annual leave. Warehouse staff rostered on a public holiday receive a compensatory day off within the same month.

5. Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to ten days of paid sick leave per year. A medical certificate is required for any absence exceeding two consecutive days. Sick leave does not accrue and cannot be carried forward or encashed.

6. Remote Working

Eligible office-based employees may work remotely up to **1 day per week**. Remote days must be agreed with the line manager and recorded in the shared team calendar. Warehouse, depot and fleet roles are not eligible for remote working due to the operational nature of those positions.

Employees working remotely are expected to be reachable during standard hours and to maintain a connection adequate for video calls. Company equipment used at home remains the property of Meridian Logistics.

7. Notice Period

After confirmation, the notice period for resignation or termination is **30 days** on either side. Payment in lieu of notice may be offered at the sole discretion of the company.

8. Code of Conduct

- Treat colleagues, clients, drivers and vendors with courtesy and respect at all times.
- Do not disclose client shipment details, pricing or volumes outside the company.
- Declare any personal interest in a supplier, vendor or client relationship to your line manager.
- Alcohol and controlled substances are prohibited on all company premises and in all company vehicles.

9. Grievances

Any employee may raise a grievance in writing to their line manager, or directly to Human Resources where the grievance concerns the line manager. Grievances are acknowledged within three working days and concluded within twenty working days. All grievance records are kept confidential and retained for three years.

10. Amendments

Human Resources reviews this handbook annually. Employees are notified of material changes by email and the current version is published on the internal portal.